

20th century

The 20th century was the time from 1901 to 2000. In the 20th century there were many events, inventions, and discoveries that changed people's lives for ever.

British
air force
symbol

A British fighter aircraft
from World War II

World wars

There were two terrible world wars during the 20th century. World War I lasted from 1914 to 1918. World War II lasted from 1939 to 1945. Millions of soldiers and civilians died in these wars.

The tracks stop the
heavy tank sinking
into mud.

Tank

Thick armour
protects the tank.



Nearly three-quarters of France's electricity is made at nuclear power stations. This one is on the River Seine.

Nuclear power

The first nuclear power station was opened in 1954. Today, there are about 400 of them in the world. These power stations make dangerous waste. Some people think they should be closed down.



This is Sirius, a ship owned and used by the Greenpeace organization.